

In *פרשת שמני*, the *ספר אפריון*, written by *רב שלמה גאנצפריד*, the *בעל קיצור שולחן ערוך*, brings down a well-known *גמרא* in *ע"ב י"ב ע"ב*. He quotes a *ברייתא* that explains the phrase *וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי*, comparing it to the *שמחה* that *הוא* had when He created *ברוך*. Just as there was *שמחה* at the beginning of creation, so too there was *שמחה* on the eighth day, when the *משכן* was inaugurated.

It connects this idea to *בראשית*, where it says: *וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר יוֹם אֶחָד*. The question arises: how do these two events compare? We know that the *מקדש* is considered *מעט עולם*, a microcosm of creation. However, the *מדרש* he brings adds an even deeper and more meaningful perspective.

The *פסוק* states: *וַיֵּשְׁמְעוּ אֶת קוֹל ה' אֱלֹהִים מִתְהַלֵּךְ בִּגְגֹן*. This indicates that *הקדוש ברוך הוא*'s original *מחשבה* was for His *שכינה* to dwell permanently in this world, among the *תחתונים*. However, once *אדם הראשון* was *חוטא*, the *שכינה* was *נסתלק* to the first *רקיע*, moving one level above this world.

Then *קין* sinned, and the *שכינה* ascended to the second *רקיע*. Because of the *דור אנוש*, it moved to the third *רקיע*. The *דור המבול* caused it to rise to the fourth *רקיע*, the *דור הפלגה* pushed it to the fifth, *סדום* led to its ascent to the sixth, and finally, in *מצרים*, the *שכינה* was *נסתלק* to the seventh and highest *רקיע*.

However, *אברהם*, *יצחק*, *יעקב*, *לוי*, *קהת*, *אֶרֶץ* sent seven *צדיקים* to bring the *שכינה* back down to *ארץ*: *משה*, *עמרם*, and *משה*. When the *משכן* was completed, the *שכינה* finally returned to this world, fulfilling *ברוך* *הקדוש*'s original desire. This is expressed in the *פסוק* (תהילים קל"ב:י"ג): *אֲנִי לְמוֹשָׁב לִי* - Hashem desired to dwell here in this world. That is why it says: *וַעֲשׂוּ לִי מִקְדָּשׁ וְשִׁכְנָתִי בְּתוֹכְכֶם* (שמות כ"ה:ח'). This teaches us that the *שכינה* had a deep *תשוקה* to return to this world. Therefore, the *שמחה* that *הוא* had on the day of *ברוך* was the same *שמחה* as on the day the *משכן* was inaugurated, because that day allowed the *שכינה* to return to the *תחתונים*.

Whenever we fulfill *וַעֲשׂוּ לִי מִקְדָּשׁ וְשִׁכְנָתִי בְּתוֹכְכֶם*, whenever we establish a *בית נאמן בישראל*, we are building a miniature *מקדש*. In the *זכות* of building a new *בישראל* - through every *חתונה*, and especially, *בעזרת* *ה'*, through the *חתונות* in our own *משפחה*, with our *קינדערלאך* and *אייניקלעך*, and for all future *דורות* - we contribute to bringing the *שכינה* back into this world. In doing so, we fulfill *הקדוש ברוך הוא*'s deepest *רצון* of *וְשִׁכְנָתִי בְּתוֹכְכֶם*.

